

FRENCH HEEL

A medium-high heel for women's shoes, in which the back curves inwards and then flares out slightly just at the base; also called *Pompadour heel*.

18TH CENTURY ▷



FRENCH HOOD A small, round hood with a stiff frame, worn far back over the crown of the head, with the ends extending forward over the ears.

1520s–1590

FRENCH KNICKERS A type of (usually loose-fitting) women's knickers or underpants, extending from the waist to the upper thighs like shorts, typically made of *lace* or *satin*; see also *Cami-knickers*, *Lingerie*.

1930s ▷

FRENCH POCKET An early form of flap pocket, comprising a horizontal slit with a flap to protect the opening; used on men's clothing.

17TH CENTURY: SEE P.453

FRENCH RUFF

Also called the *cartwheel ruff*, a large, deep ruff forming a horseshoe shape or full circle around the neck.

1580s–c.1610



FRENCH SEAM A seam in which the raw edges are enclosed within the body of the seam; especially suitable for sheer fabrics.

FRET A *coif* or skull cap made of gold fretwork or of fabric.

FROCK Old term for an informal gown or a child's dress; now an alternative word for a dress.

MEDIEVAL ▷

FROCK COAT A man's coat reaching to the knee, buttoned down to waist level, and with full skirts.

18TH–EARLY 20TH CENTURY: SEE PP.184–5

FROGGING A coat closure comprising decorative braid and a spindle-shaped "frog button" that passes through a loop in the braid.

17TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.113, 205, 436

FRONTLET A decorative band worn across a woman's forehead, under a veil or other head covering.

MEDIEVAL–EARLY 17TH CENTURY

FULL-BOTTOMED WIG A large wig of closely curled hair, shoulder-length or longer, with a centre parting.

1660–EARLY 18TH CENTURY: SEE PP.131, 137

FUN FUR A fur-like material made from synthetic fibre, often dyed a bright colour, or a garment made from such material.

1960s ▷

FURBELOW A *flounce*, or a wavy line of fabric, usually on a woman's garment and often made of the same material as the main garment.

18TH CENTURY

FUSTANELLA White *pleated* skirt traditionally worn as part of military dress in Albania and Greece; made from thick *linen*, often dipped in animal fat for waterproofing.

c.13TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.453

G

GABARDINE A *worsted* or *cotton/* *worsted twill* with diagonal *ribbing*, invented by Thomas Burberry; used to make weatherproof raincoats and the Burberry *trenchcoat*.

1879 ▷

GABRIELLE DRESS Dress with a skirt front, a *bodice* cut from one panel of fabric, and *box pleats* at the back; also known as Agnes Sorel or *fourreau*.

1860s

GABRIELLE SLEEVE A sleeve used on women's dresses, full from shoulder to elbow and tapering to a deep *cuff*; also a sleeve with a series of *puffs* from shoulder to wrist.

19TH CENTURY

GALLIGASKINS Wide, loose *breeches*.

1570s–END OF 17TH CENTURY

GARÇONNE LOOK A style named for the French equivalent of the "flapper", with short hairstyles and an often androgynous shape to the clothes.

1920s: SEE PP.252–3

GARTER A band, often decorative, used to hold up the top of a stocking.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.101, 104



GATHERING To make a fabric edge shorter and more full by sewing a line of *running stitch* and bunching the material closely along the thread.

MEDIEVAL ▷

GAUCHO PANTS Wide, calf-length trousers first worn by the gauchos of South America but made popular by film star Rudolph Valentino.

1920s ▷

GAUNTLET An armoured covering for the hand; also a sturdy glove with a flared *cuff* extending over the wrist.

15TH CENTURY ▷

GAUZE A thin, fine fabric made from *silk* or a similarly sheer material, used for veils and dress trimmings.

13TH CENTURY ▷

GEORGETTE A light, sheer fabric of *silk* or synthetic fibre, with a *crêpe* texture, used in dresses and blouses.

1914 ▷

GHILLIES Soft, open-topped leather shoes secured by laces across the foot and around the ankle, worn with traditional Scottish dress.

GIBUS HAT A *top hat* with a collapsible crown; see also *Opera hat*.

19TH CENTURY ▷

GIGOT A sleeve that is very full from the shoulder to the elbow and fitted from elbow to wrist; also called a "leg-of-mutton" sleeve.

19TH CENTURY: SEE PP.179, 206–7, 209, 458

GINGHAM *Checked* or striped plain weave fabric, usually *cotton*, in

which the pattern is made by stripes of *warp* and *weft* threads.

19TH CENTURY ▷

GIORNEA *Tabard*-style overdress with open front and sides, worn in Renaissance Italy by wealthy women as a way of displaying expensive fabric; especially popular in Florence.

LATE 14TH–MID-15TH CENTURY: SEE P.81

GIPON A close-fitting, padded jacket worn by men over the shirt; the forerunner of the *doublet*.

14TH CENTURY

GIRDLE (a) A belt or cord fastened around the waist or hips to secure the clothing; (b) an elasticated *corset*.

ANTIQUITY ▷: SEE PP.25, 87, 107

GOSETS Triangular panels sewn into the seams of a skirt to create a fluted, flared shape at the bottom.

19TH CENTURY ▷



GOFFERING Creation of frills on *cotton*, *linen*, or delicate garments, by pressing the edges with heated tongs (goffering irons).

16TH CENTURY ▷

GO-GO BOOTS Knee-high boots for women, with a low or flat heel and often a chunky toe, inspired by "Space Age" style; usually made in shiny white or brightly coloured material such as patent leather or vinyl.

1960s ▷: SEE PP.352, 361

GOLLAR Short, fitted cape that just covers the shoulders, upper chest, and upper back; fastened at the front; worn in Renaissance Germany with low-cut gowns; often fur-lined.

EARLY–MID 16TH CENTURY: SEE P.86

GOSES Tapered panels used to make a skirt fit closely around the hips but flare out at the bottom.

14TH CENTURY ▷

GOSSAMER A very light, fine, filmy fabric, often used for veils.

19TH CENTURY ▷